



WSJ

THE WALL STREET JOURNAL WEEKEND

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What's News

Business & Finance

- ◆ **The Dow finished** Friday at an all-time high as the index rose 0.58%. The S&P 500 rose 0.37%, as it wrapped up an eighth-consecutive week of gains. The Nasdaq gained 0.19%. **A1**
- ◆ **Lenovo recorded** its fastest revenue growth in years and targets hitting the \$100 billion sales milestone within the next two years. **B10**
- ◆ **At least two senior** Walmart executives are leaving the company, a reshuffling of the executive ranks after new CEO John Furner took over in February. **B11**
- ◆ **SpaceX launched** an upgraded version of its Starship rocket, a vehicle that has posed tough challenges over the course of a costly development campaign. **B11**
- ◆ **BJ's Wholesale logged** higher sales in its fiscal first quarter as inflation-weary consumers continued to flock to the warehouse club. **B10**
- ◆ **Booz Allen Hamilton** reported higher fiscal fourth-quarter profit as its cost-cutting initiatives helped to offset declines in revenue. **B11**
- ◆ **Cartier owner Richemont** reported an acceleration in sales growth for its most recent quarter despite a hit from the Middle East conflict, saying it benefited from strong jewelry demand. **B11**

Worldwide

- ◆ **Kevin Warsh was sworn in** as the Fed chairman, with President Trump again pressing the case for lower rates even as he said he wanted the central bank's new leader to operate independently. **A1**
- ◆ **Tulsi Gabbard resigned** as director of national intelligence, capping a tenure in which she was largely sidelined from Trump's national-security operations. **A1**
- ◆ **China and Russia have** in recent years expanded intelligence operations in Cuba, officials familiar with U.S. intelligence assessments said. **A1**
- ◆ **Most green-card** applicants will need to go abroad to apply for permanent residency at an American consulate, rather than filing from within the U.S. **A3**
- ◆ **Trump plans to send** 5,000 troops to Poland, a move that won't forestall the White House's effort to shrink the U.S. military presence in Europe. **A6**
- ◆ **One person died** and 36 people were injured after a fire and two explosions at a New York City shipyard. **A7**

OPINION

Falling birthrates are a mystery. **A13**

NOTICE TO READERS

WSJ.com and WSJ mobile apps will publish throughout the holiday weekend. The Wall Street Journal print edition won't be published on Monday, Memorial Day.

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President Trump claps Kevin Warsh's hand during his swearing-in as Federal Reserve chairman.

Warsh Takes Reins at Fed As Prices Rise

By Nick Timiraos
And Matt Grossman

Kevin Warsh was sworn in Friday as the next Federal Reserve chairman, with President Trump again pressing the economic case for lower rates even as he said he wanted the central bank's new leader to operate independently.

"I want Kevin to be totally independent," Trump said at the White House. "Don't look at me. Don't look at anybody."

Moments later, the president laid out the view he hopes the new chairman will carry into office: that the economy needn't be reined in, and that strong growth doesn't cause inflation. "We want to stop inflation," Trump said, "but we

don't want to stop greatness."

Those dueling benedictions point to the challenge ahead for Warsh, who could find it difficult to persuade his new colleagues that the low rates Trump wants are advisable. The conditions that would support cuts—falling inflation, a cooling labor market—have moved out of reach.

The war in Iran, launched a month after Trump chose Warsh for the job, has only heightened price pressures, and the artificial-intelligence boom is looking like an engine of demand. Long-term bond yields are climbing, and a growing

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◆ **Feeding a crowd is costlier this Memorial Day..... A3**

Gabbard Resigns as Intelligence Director

Tulsi Gabbard resigned Friday as director of national intelligence, capping a tumultuous tenure in which she was largely sidelined from President Trump's national-security operations, including in Venezuela and Iran.

By Meridith McGraw,
Josh Dawsey,
Brian Schwartz
and Alexander Ward

In a letter Friday to Trump later posted on social media, Gabbard wrote that she is resigning because her husband, Abraham Williams, "has recently been diagnosed with an extremely rare form of bone cancer."

"I must step away from public service to be by his side and fully support him through this battle," Gabbard wrote. Gabbard said her last day would be June 30, staying on temporarily to help ensure "no disruption in leadership or momentum."

Trump, in a social-media post, said Gabbard had done "an incredible job" and noted that Aaron Lukas, Gabbard's deputy, would serve as the acting director.

Trump's second-term cabinet has had more staying power than his first term's, when ousters were common. He cycled through five directors or acting directors of na-

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Iran Moved Billions Through Binance to Finance Regime

As Iran braced for conflict with the U.S., a key regime financier built a secret payment network to keep money flowing

By Angus Berwick,
Patricia Kowsmann
and Ben Foldy

to its military forces. At its core was Binance.

Until as recently as December, the network, run by Babak Zanjani, an Iranian who is a self-

described "antisancion" operator, made \$850 million in transactions over two years on the world's largest cryptocurrency exchange, mostly on a single trading account, internal Binance compliance reports show.

Zanjani allies, including a sister, a romantic partner and a director of Zanjani's company, ran additional accounts, all accessed from the same devices—a pattern the Binance investigators flagged in their reports as evi-

dence the group was evading U.S. sanctions on Iran.

Even after multiple internal flags on the activity, the main account continued to operate over a period of at least 15 months and was open as of January, according to the Binance reports. Zanjani's use of Binance hasn't been previously reported.

The funds are part of billions in crypto transactions that have flowed through Binance to networks financing Iran's Islamic

Revolutionary Guard Corps in the two years preceding the current U.S.-Iran war, according to Binance compliance reports, blockchain data, foreign law-enforcement officials who track terrorism financing and other crypto researchers and nonpublic documents.

Foreign law-enforcement of-

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◆ **Mediators race to set deal on Iran..... A7**

EXCHANGE



INTERGALACTIC IPO

The painstaking, low-tech path to SpaceX's stratospheric offering. **B1**

U.S. Sees More China, Russia Spying in Cuba

By Alexander Ward
And Vera Bergengruen

China and Russia have in recent years expanded their intelligence operations in Cuba, investing in electronic-eavesdropping facilities used to spy on U.S. military sites in Florida and roughly tripling the number of intelligence personnel to staff them since 2023, officials familiar with U.S. intelligence assessments said.

The findings suggest Beijing and Moscow see their posts as increasingly vital, adding more up-to-date equipment within listening range of two U.S. military headquarters overseeing operations in the Middle East and Latin America.

Despite years of intelligence

activity by China and Russia on the island, Washington is using the issue to sharpen its case for escalating its pressure on Cuba.

The assessments come as the U.S. has declared Cuba "an unusual and extraordinary threat" to national security, asserting the communist state is a host for Washington's adversaries.

"Other presidents have looked at this for 50, 60 years" without doing anything President Trump said Thursday, referring to the threat Cuba poses to the U.S. "It looks like I'll be the one that does it."

Cuba denies it serves as a base for U.S. enemies or threatens the U.S. Earlier this week, Foreign Minister Bruno Rodriguez accused the Trump

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Disney Turns to a Puppet to Break A Star Wars Box-Office Funk

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An animatronic 'Baby Yoda' is being trotted out on red carpets like a celebrity

By John Jurgensen

The breakout star of the celebrity summer-movie circuit is a wrinkly green puppet.

At a time when the entertainment world is stuffed with hyper-realistic digital effects and generative AI can conjure most anything from thin air, Disney has put one of its most important franchises on the shoulders of a tiny analog creation.

The knee-high space creature—known as Grogu,

Baby Yoda or just, as his human minders often call him, "the baby"—is a main character in the first Star Wars movie to hit theaters in nearly seven years, "The Mandalorian and Grogu."

The character first made a splash in a Disney+ TV series more than six years ago. But if his command of the red carpet lately is any indicator, the kid has staying power.

An animatronic puppet has been trotted out like a real-life celebrity

A new Force? Please turn to page A9



War, Energy Pressures, AI Jitters Fail to Dent Market's Record Run

By Krystal Hur

Investors just can't get enough of stocks these days.

War in the Middle East, the largest energy shock in history and worries about artificial intelligence have done little to cool their ardor. Major indexes are back at records.

The character first made a splash in a Disney+ TV series more than six years ago. But if his command of the red carpet lately is any indicator, the kid has staying power.

An animatronic puppet has been trotted out like a real-life celebrity

A new Force? Please turn to page A9

are particularly enthusiastic about stocks that would benefit from a reacceleration in economic growth, with holdings of so-called cyclical stocks exceeding those of defensive shares that investors buy for relative stability by the largest amount since 2018.

The Dow Jones Industrial Average just notched its first record since February and finished Friday at an all-time high around 50,580 points. The S&P 500 wrapped up an eighth-consecutive week of gains, its longest such streak since December 2023.

"All of the ingredients of this rally have held in there,"

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Index performance this past week

